folklorist and a scholar of VOC—the visit could have never been productive. His support continued over many visits in subsequent years.

In 1995, I joined the Department of History of Manonmaniam Sundaranar University as the faculty, and Tirunelveli became my home for the next six years. I lived and breathed the air that made VOC and the Swadeshi movement.

A letter of introduction from T. Amarnath, then assistant registrar of companies, Chennai, enabled access to the Madura Coats Ltd, the successor to the Harvey Mills at Tuticorin and Madurai. I still remember the diffidence of the manager of the Tuticorin Chamber of Commerce about showing me the records that he rightly believed showed his employer in poor light. I was also able to look at some records in Madura Coats Archives, Madurai.

No records of SSNCo could be traced in the office of the registrar of companies, Chennai. They were likely transferred at the time of the company's liquidation. Though the liquidation proceedings of SSNCo took place in the district court of Tirunelveli, no records have survived there. A thorough search carried out by the chief judicial magistrate, S. Manojkumar proved futile. G.R. Swaminathan, judge of the Madras High Court went out of his way to help in this search.

I could acquire the pictures of B.K. Ramaier and A. Sundara Sastri at the then Bank of Tamilnadu's Tirunelveli head office in 1985. The photographs had to be taken with a camera from the life-size portraits hanging on the wall at an angle. That explains the poor quality of the pictures. After the bank's amalgamation with the Indian Overseas Bank, the portraits seem to have gone missing.

Mandayam S. Parthasarathy, the son of S. Srinivasachari, who died during the pandemic as a centenarian, provided me with a copy of his father's unpublished memoirs.

A.P.C.V. Chockalingam provided many leads on the identity of the traders of Tuticorin associated with the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company. I deeply regret not probing him on my first meetings with him in